



FIREDIES | STREAM DECK SERIES



METRICS

OWNER'S MANUAL

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FIREDIES PRODUCTIONS · OXFORD · FD-2026-MT-V1.0

The real number. Every second.

Metrics puts your machine on your deck—CPU, memory, graphics, video memory and disk—updating once a second, calm green when it's idle and warming to red as it works. No drivers to install, no administrator prompt, nothing to sign into.

It reads the same performance counters Task Manager reads, so the number on the key is the number Windows itself would show you. If a reading can't be taken, the face says so instead of guessing.

02 QUICK START

1. Drag CPU (under **Metrics**) onto any key or dial.
2. That's it. It's already live—there is nothing to configure to make it work.
3. Open its settings when you want a different style, your own colors, or a different thing to happen when you press it.

03 THE FIVE

CPU	How hard the processor is working, as a percentage. The Task Manager number.
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RAM	Memory in use—in gigabytes, or as a share of the whole.
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GPU	Graphics load. Intel, AMD and NVIDIA alike, no vendor tool needed.
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VRAM	Video memory in use, against your card's own total.
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Disk	How busy a drive is—or, if you prefer, how full it is.
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Every one works as a **key** or as a **dial**, and you can put as many on a deck as you like—they all share a single reading, so ten faces cost no more than one.

Pick how it reads.

Color bar	The number plus a bar underneath. Green when idle, red under load, and it glows when the meter is pegged.
B & W	Monochrome. The bar brightens as the load climbs—the whole story, no color at all.
Clean	Just the number, large. Leave color on and the number itself carries the load.
History	The bar becomes a live graph of the last ~15 seconds. Oldest on the left, now on the right.

The style is per face, so a CPU key and a CPU dial on the same deck can look completely different.

05 COLOR THAT MEANS SOMETHING

Out of the box the color is the reading: calm green below 10%, travelling through amber, red above 90%, and—on the color bar—a red glow at 97% and over. Both of those percentages are yours to move. Left at their defaults, a Disk face set to Capacity uses a wider pair of its own—70 and 95—because a drive that is 15% full is not an emergency.

- **Personalize the load colors**—choose your own calm, working and busy shades and the whole ramp is rebuilt between them.
- **Reverse it**—busy reads green and idle reads red. Useful when a meter climbing is the thing you *want* to see.
- **One fixed color instead**—turn the load coloring off and the bar simply stays the color you chose.
- **The glyph has its own color**—each meter arrives with its own accent (CPU amber, RAM blue, GPU violet, VRAM green, Disk yellow) and any of them can be changed.

There is a **Reset colors to default** button, so nothing you try is a one-way door.

06 THE SMALL PRINT ON THE FACE

- **Show the unit**—turn off the % or GB and the number gets the whole face to itself.
- **Number aligned**—left, middle or right, on dials. Left by default, so the number lines up with the icon and the bar. Keys are always centered.
- **Dials show a second reading**. The thread count on CPU, your card's total on VRAM, free space on Disk—drawn small on the right, where a key has no room for it.

Two readings, two gestures.

RAM, VRAM and Disk can each be read two ways—the amount, or the share. So on those three:

Tap	Flips the reading. GB becomes %, and on Disk activity becomes capacity.
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Hold	Opens Task Manager—or whatever you chose instead.
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CPU and GPU have only one reading each, so they never gain a gesture that would do nothing. On those two, **tap** opens your chosen app and **hold** can open a second one.

The choices are Task Manager, Resource Monitor, File Explorer, Control Panel and Settings—plus **DirectX Diagnostic** on GPU and VRAM, and **Open this drive** on Disk. Or nothing at all, if you would rather the key just reported.

A hold is **450 ms**. There's a click sound on press—your own file if you want one—and a volume slider for it.

08 THE DISK FACE

Disk is the one with the most to say, so it asks two questions.

- **Which drive**—any single physical disk, or **All disks** together.
- **What to show**—**Activity**, how hard it is working right now, or **Capacity**, how much is taken and how much is free.
- **The drive letter replaces the glyph**, so a wall of disk keys tells you which is which at a glance.

Capacity is a fact rather than a rate, so on that setting the History graph steps aside and the bar returns—a graph of a number that barely moves would be a graph that lies about being interesting.

Windows' own counters. Nothing else.

Every reading is taken from an interface that ships with Windows—the same performance counters Task Manager and Resource Monitor read, plus the standard system queries for memory, volumes and your card's own reported size. There is no kernel driver, no service, no administrator prompt, and nothing to install beyond the plugin itself.

CPU	Processor Information · % Processor Utility, across all cores.
RAM	Total visible memory less free physical memory.
GPU	GPU Engine · 3D utilization, summed across engines.
VRAM	GPU Adapter Memory · dedicated usage, against the card's reported size.
Disk	Physical Disk · idle time, inverted. Capacity from the logical volumes.

Readings are sampled about once a second and lightly smoothed across three samples, which is what stops a meter flickering while still catching a real spike. The History graph holds the last sixteen of them.

10 ONE READER FOR THE WHOLE DECK

However many meters you place, there is only ever **one** reader running. All five kinds come from a single sampling loop, so a deck with ten Metrics faces costs the same as a deck with one—and a face that is scrolled off your current page costs nothing at all.

The live History graph animates only while a History face is actually on screen, and the reader shuts down entirely when the last meter is removed. Nothing keeps ticking in the background because you tried it once.

We'd rather tell you now.

- **GPU and VRAM need a modern Windows.** The graphics counters arrived in Windows 10 build 1709. On anything older, or on a machine whose driver doesn't publish them, those two faces show a dash rather than an invented number.
 - **GPU is 3D load, not everything a card does.** Video encoding, decoding and compute run on their own engines and are deliberately not folded in—so the number matches what Task Manager's 3D graph shows you, not a larger figure that would flatter us.
 - **VRAM totals come from the driver.** Where a card doesn't report its size, the share is estimated against 8 GB and the gigabyte reading stays exact. On a laptop with two graphics chips the used figure covers both, while the total is read once from the first adapter Windows lists—so the share can read high or low.
 - **Disk activity is how busy, not how fast.** A drive can be at 100% while moving very little, if what it's moving is scattered. That's the counter's meaning, and we don't dress it up as a speed.
 - **Windows only, for now.** Every one of these counters is a Windows interface.
 - **Nothing leaves your PC.** No account, no sign-up, no analytics, no network call of any kind. The numbers are read on your machine and drawn on your deck.
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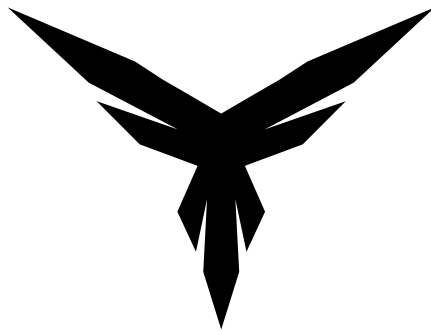
12 FREE

Metrics is free—all five meters, every style, no locked buttons and no trial timer. So is **Macro X**: one key that runs your whole routine.

If they earn their place on your deck, the paid Firedies plugins are what keep them alive: **Ping** (live latency and a speed test), **Focus** (pomodoro, timer, clock & calendar), **Rank Showcase** (your rank, live) and **Now Playing** (what's playing, with the accent taken from the cover).

Free, from Firedies Productions · Windows 10/11 · Stream Deck 6.5+

Docs and support: github.com/FirediesProductions/stream-deck



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